

Themes, bets and the "magic quadrant"

Traditional Gantt-based roadmaps assume the work is known. AI work is often 40% discovery, 40% experimentation, 20% build. That is why Indian AI teams that ship quarterly release ROADMAPS BY THEME, not by feature-list.

When did your last AI roadmap last longer than a quarter?

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Gantt vs Theme-based
- 02 Anatomy of a theme
- 03 Cost × Uncertainty quadrant
- 04 Kill criteria — no-sunk-cost
- 05 Review cadence

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

AI is not a feature — it is a research programme disguised as a roadmap.

NUMBER 1

40%

From real-world deployments.

NUMBER 2

40%

From real-world deployments.

NUMBER 3

20%

From real-world deployments.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

Why AI roadmaps break classic Gantt charts.

2

Build a theme-based roadmap.

3

Classify bets by cost $\times$ uncertainty.

4

Kill a bet fast (no-sunk-cost rule).

5

One-slide roadmap for review.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

Gantt vs Theme-based

Key concept of this lesson.

02

Anatomy of a theme

6 fields, one card

03

Cost × Uncertainty quadrant

Which bets to run

04

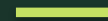
Kill criteria — no-sunk-cost

How senior AI-PMs stay credible

01

PART 1 OF 4

Gantt vs Theme-based



Key concept of this lesson.

CONCEPT 1 OF 4

Gantt vs Theme-based

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

DEFINITION

Gantt vs Theme-based

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

CONCEPT 2 OF 4

Anatomy of a theme

Name (user-visible outcome).

Hypothesis ("We believe ____ because ____").

Metric + target.

Bets: 2-4 candidate approaches.

Kill criteria.

Review cadence.

CARD

6 fields

Fits on a slide.

KEY POINTS

- Name (user-visible outcome)
- Hypothesis ("We believe ____ because ____")
- Metric + target
- Bets: 2-4 candidate approaches

CONCEPT 3 OF 4

Cost × Uncertainty quadrant

Low-cost / Low-uncertainty → JUST DO IT.

Low-cost / High-uncertainty → SPIKE / POC.

High-cost / Low-uncertainty → SCHEDULE.

High-cost / High-uncertainty → RESEARCH + GATE.

2×2

4 moves

No heroics in top-right.

DEFINITION

Cost × Uncertainty quadrant

Which bets to run

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

CONCEPT 4 OF 4

Kill criteria — no-sunk-cost

Pre-declare "we will stop if X is not true by date Y".

Weekly review of leading metric.

Sunset ritual: learnings logged, team redeployed.

Kill fast + cheap > ship slow + bad.

DISCIPLINE

Kill early

Protects next bet.

KEY POINTS

- Pre-declare "we will stop if X is not true by date Y"
- Weekly review of leading metric
- Sunset ritual: learnings logged, team redeployed
- Kill fast + cheap > ship slow + bad

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Draw a 1-slide theme roadmap

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

1

2

3

4

Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

Which feature on your roadmap is actually a research bet?

Q2

What kill criteria would you regret not setting?

Q3

Does your review cadence match discovery speed?

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check

Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

Theme cards should fit on:

A

6 slides

B

1 slide

C

30 slides

D

Infinite

Theme cards should fit on:



CORRECT ANSWER

1 slide

WHY

One-slide discipline

High cost + high uncertainty =:

A

Just do it

B

Schedule

C

Research + gate

D

Ignore

High cost + high uncertainty =:



CORRECT ANSWER

Research + gate

WHY

Gate serious spend on learning

AI roadmap re-plans on:

A

Slippage

B

Learning

C

Holidays

D

Funding

AI roadmap re-plans on:

CORRECT ANSWER



Learning

WHY

Learning is the trigger

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How this lesson plays out in one real Indian context

THE SCENARIO

A team applies the lesson's main idea to a real workflow — and the results show up within a quarter.

THE TAKEAWAY

"The best AI PMs kill bets faster than they ship them."

WHAT TO NOTICE

- 1 Gantt vs Theme-based
- 2 Anatomy of a theme
- 3 Cost × Uncertainty quadrant
- 4 Kill criteria — no-sunk-cost

1-slide roadmap

Build a 1-slide theme roadmap for YOUR week-10 product.

DELIVERABLES

- Pick 3 themes.
- Write 2-4 bets per theme.
- Add kill criteria per bet.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

Deliverable: 1 slide posted on LMS forum.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

"The best AI PMs kill bets faster than they ship them."

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 10

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

NEXT → Lesson 4 — User Research.